DSA 210 – Project Proposal
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Motivation: In this project, I will analyze international air traffic across European countries between the years 2016 and 2022 by focusing on country-level differences. I aim to understand how economic conditions and policy-related factors influence the distribution of air traffic between countries. In particular, I will examine how GDP per capita and visa acceptance rates relate to the volume of international flights, and how these factors may shape both inbound and outbound travel patterns.

Research Question : To what extent do GDP per capita and visa acceptance rates explain the differences in inbound and outbound international air traffic across European countries?

Data Source: The foundation of my project is a dataset containing nearly 650.000 flight records from airports across Europe. It tracks daily departures and arrivals, along with Instrument Flight Rules (IFR) movements.

Enrichment: Since I will be using a public dataset, I plan to enrich the project by merging it with additional country-level data sources:

- Schengen Visa Statistics: I will collect Schengen visa application and approval statistics from official European Commission (Schengen) sources. Higher visa approval rates are expected to be associated with increased inbound air traffic.

- GDP Per Capita: This will be used as an indicator of a country's economic strength and purchasing power. I will obtain this data from the World Bank database. I expect that countries with higher GDP per capita will generate more outbound travel and possibly attract more inbound traffic as well.

- Population Data: I will use population figures to normalize air traffic values, enabling more meaningful comparisons across countries. This data will also be obtained from the World Bank.